

Main

Report Name (Org_Country_Year_Report Type)

ILRI_Kenya_2024-25_3-month Report

Fellowship Organization

International Livestock Research Institute (ILRI)

Fellowship City

Nairobi

Fellowship Country

Kenya

Fellowship Start Date

07/01/2024

Anticipated Fellowship End Date

07/01/2025

What is your fellowship title/role?

Princeton in Africa Communications Fellow

What are your primary responsibilities?

Work closely with the communication team in developing key messages for major ILRI events and campaigns to promote relevant policy or science messages

Review and approve social media content content in adherence with ILRI's guidelines

Write and edit web stories

Design illustrations for socials, reports, publications and newsletters

Cover ILRI events and research projects through photography/ videography

Ideate concepts for social media marketing

I receive adequate direction and support to perform my fellowship responsibilities.

Strongly Agree

Did you receive any sort of orientation, handover or onboarding when you started your fellowship?

Yes

Please describe your orientation/onboarding and note who handled it.

The Fellow before me onboarded me on my role. Other individuals onboarded me on the following:

-social media

-ILRI's Capacity development

-my first outreach job in Isiolo

-admin issues at ILRI

If you did not receive any kind of orientation, what information or guidance were you provided at the start of your fellowship?**Describe a representative day at work.**

Mostly begin my day with a workout on campus. Grab breakfast then get to the office. I mostly plan my day, journal, respond to emails and check my itinerary with the hour. I may design some social media assets, shoot or edit videos that will go to social or help cover events on campus. Sit in meetings as well to go through and align on current and future events. I come up with the social media messages that go out and help manage interaction on the accounts.

On average, how many hours per week do you work?

40

How would you describe your effectiveness in your fellowship post so far?

Very Effective

Please briefly describe 1-2 specific projects that you have undertaken or accomplishments you have made so far.

I designed physical banners and social media assets for the Africa Food Systems Forum in Kigali which were used at ILRI's side event. I did the same social media assets for other events like Climate Week NYC and Norman E. Borlaug dialogue

I helped document ILRI's work in Index Based Livestock Insurance in Isiolo County looking at the marketability of bundled livestock insurance options.

What is your organization's work culture like?**What is your office environment like? Please comment on the size and structure of the office(s) where you do most of your work.**

Open plan. I work at the info centre which is ILRI's library. Its a nice conducive space to work

To whom do you report?

The Head of Communications is my overall supervisor. He mostly directs me to specific people who can have me on projects that they are working on. Also he assigns me work for major events like ILRI@50.

I check in with the Head of Social Media more or less daily to touch base on social media messages going out on ILRI's platforms. We both manage ILRI's social accounts.

The head of outreach assigns me work that deals with how ILRI is showing up in communities and other functions like COPs by the UN or The IBLI job in Isiolo.

The head of publishing assigns me most work dealing with publishing. I help him design assets that go into our publications.

The head of editorial assigns me the events that I cover on campus.

Have you had an initial check-in with your supervisor to set up a work plan and to set goals for your work during your fellowship year?

Yes

Was this meeting helpful in understanding your role and setting goals for your fellowship year?

Yes

Please explain why you have not met with your supervisor and if you have plans to do so going forward.

Please briefly indicate 3-5 professional goals you have for the rest of your fellowship year. Your professional goals should align with your work plan.

Understanding how to communicate for development
Networking with professionals in the development world
Upskill professional skills
Get a sense of what to pursue for grad school

How often do you check in with your supervisor?

Weekly

Have you had an opportunity to travel for work so far?

Yes

Describe this travel opportunity. Include location(s) and a brief description of the purpose of the trip(s).

Travelled to Isiolo County in Kenya to document ILRI's work in Index Based Livestock Insurance looking at the marketability of bundled livestock insurance options.

I feel adequately prepared for my position's professional responsibilities.

Strongly Agree

Please briefly explain your response.

My role relies strongly on my past experience in the media which has really helped in me settling in and picking up the role quicker.

Life at Fellowship Site

How did you travel to your host country and site? Please be specific

N/A

What kind of visa/ permit do you have or applied for?

N/A

How did you obtain (or are obtaining) your visa or permit?

N/A

Did you apply for and receive your visa / permit before heading to your host country or after arriving?

N/A

What costs were associated with obtaining your visa or permit?

N/A

Did you pay the visa / permit costs or were they covered by your organization?

N/A

Are you still having challenges obtaining your visa/ permit?

No

If yes, please explain further

g) Do you have any suggestions to help future Fellows navigate the visa / permit application process?

N/A

What vaccinations were you required to obtain prior to your departure? How much did your vaccinations cost? Did you get a yellow fever vaccination?

N/A

How was your arrival and first week in your host country? Any improvements that could streamline the assimilation process for future Fellows?

N/A

Is housing provided by and/or paid for by your organization? Please explain.

I pay for my own housing from my stipend after taxes

Do you live in a location that is more urban or rural?

Very Urban

Please describe your living environment

Studio apartment near other apartments and some informal settlements. Is about a 10 minute drive from ILRI. It has a mix of both young professionals and students.

How do you typically travel between your home and your work? How much does your daily transportation cost and how long is your commute?

I Uber to work at 1.6\$ daily

I take the ILRI van from work

If you live in a more rural area, what are the closest urban areas you can travel to for shopping, airport, larger medical centers, etc.?

N/A

How is the weather in your host country? What season are you presently in?

Calm- No extremities

What is the appropriate clothing for work and outside of work at your fellowship post and in your community in general?

Smart Casual/ Business Casual/ Official

How have you been spending your free time?

Nature walks, Concerts, New Restaurants, Events, Movie night, Book clubs, Art Clubs etc. Theres always something happening in Nairobi so it helps

I've been able to successfully navigate my personal/social life both back at home and at my fellowship post.

Strongly Agree

Please briefly explain your response below.

Yes. I'm home so its more or less the same.

Would you say you live and work in a safe area?

Yes. Negligible.

What precautions do you take to ensure your safety?

ISOS
Following discourse on social media

What has been your experience with crime so far? (Please note that any security or safety concerns or incidents should be reported directly to PiAf staff per PiAf safety and security protocol.)

Nothing bad to report

Describe the incidence of crime and the general security situation within your city/town. Could you recommend specific areas future Fellows might consider for safe housing? What about areas that should be avoided?

Nairobi is a mix of both safe and unsafe areas. This year Kilimani has been a fave for most fellows. However I recommend working with the org to get referrals when new then adjusting a couple of months in once you get settled.

Please refer back to the goals you set for yourself before orientation. Are you working towards these goals? Have you met any of them? Changed any of them? Please explain.

My goals were to learn how to create a multifaceted approach that considers environmental sustainability, animal welfare, public health, and social equity in the design and management of livestock farming systems, learn how to communicate those solutions in an African context, and get out of my comfort space and create impact in the world I live in. I feel I am doing so. Learning a lot about some of the good work ILRI is doing in communities and how to work within that space. I'm taking more chances and saying yes to many new experiences which is amazing.

Do you have any frustrations with your living arrangements, your work or your life outside of work?

No

Has there been anything that you have needed but have not been able to locate or acquire?

No

How have you dealt with "culture shock"?

The shock hasn't been so much for me since I'm in my home country. Though meeting so many people from different places I'm embracing different perspectives and that has been a huge eye opener for me.

What about your experience thus far has been the most...surprising?

That the workload may even surpass that of mainstream media. Simply because everything is project based. So you lend support to teams in different capacities. I never expected that coming in but appreciate the dynamic nature of the work.

What about your experience thus far has been the most...challenging?

Taking initiative to create new ideas to support the organisation. I think of innovating something great as a challenge to myself.

What are the top 3 things you miss the most from your home country or the U.S.?

N/A

What are the top 3 things about life in your host country that beat out life in your home country or the U.S.?

N/A

How is your stipend being paid?

Money to a local account in Kenya shillings monthly

How are you receiving your stipend funds?

Wire

Did you raise funds to cover part of your fellowship expenses?

No

Please list any additional one-time or infrequent expenses not included in your monthly budget below.

Monthly Budget

Rent	Utilities	Furnishings	Phone	Home Security	Internet
\$163.00	\$100.00	\$100.00	\$24.00	\$0.00	\$24.00
Transportation	Fitness	Entertainment	Groceries	House Cleaning	Eating Out
\$100.00	\$40.00	\$70.00	\$100.00	\$0.00	\$65.00
Medications	Additional Health Insurance	Travel	Laundry	Other	Total Monthly Budget (Minus Entertainment & Travel)
\$20.00	\$0.00	\$100.00	\$24.00	\$0.00	0.00
Specify "Other"					

Final Thoughts

Please briefly explain your response about Orientation.

Covered most areas we would deal with

Is there anything in particular that PiAf could cover at orientation that would have better prepared you for your fellowship post? Please specify.

Taxes. I lose quite a huge sum of my stipend because I am billed as a Kenyan national on payroll. It's easier for the organisation to do so maybe because of auditing purposes but that was a shocker for sure.

Are you receiving sufficient support, materials and information from the Princeton in Africa office? What could we improve?

Yes

As we plan the upcoming PiAf Retreat, we hope to incorporate some Fellow suggestions into our programming. What are some topics or sessions you would like to see at the Retreat? (We appreciate your feedback however, we may not be able to accommodate all suggestions or requests this year.)

Keep up the good work